

**ECON 5065F / ECON 4880V**  
**Challenges in Canadian Economic Policy**  
**Fall 2025 (September 3 – December 3)**

## **COURSE INFORMATION**

**Instructor:** Vivian Hoffmann

**Office:** 5140 Richcraft Hall

**Email:** [vivianhoffmann@cunet.carleton.ca](mailto:vivianhoffmann@cunet.carleton.ca)

I generally respond to emails within 24 hours.

**Office hours:** Wednesday 3:30:5:30 (by appointment)

**Classroom:** Online, synchronous

**Time:** Wednesday 6:05-8:55

**Link to Brightspace Course Page:**

<https://brightspace.carleton.ca/d2l/home/373307>

## **I. COURSE DESCRIPTION**

This class provides a non-technical introduction to current policy debates in Canada from a micro-economic perspective. Class meetings will consist of lectures and discussion of assigned readings.

## **II. PRECLUSIONS**

None

## **III. LEARNING OUTCOMES**

By the end of the course, students should be able to:

- Learn about current policy challenges and debates in Canada, related to climate change, labour productivity, housing, immigration, and health care
- Apply economic thinking to the analysis of these debates
- Understand and communicate economic arguments related to a current policy debate

## **IV. COURSE EXPECTATIONS**

We will meet once per week online, for 2.5 hours (with a 20-minute break halfway through the session). Students are expected to have read and/or listened to the assigned material ahead of time and to come to class prepared to discuss these. The amount of reading and listening time per week will vary but is expected to take no more than 5 hours. Listening or estimated reading times for each item are indicated below. Written reflections on the readings, submitted ahead of most classes, plus active participation in discussions, constitute most of the grade for this class.

## **V. REQUIRED MATERIALS**

- Most of the course materials are available online and linked below. Those which are not will be made available via Brightspace.

## **VI. COURSE CALENDAR**

**1. Introduction / review: economic analysis of public policy (Sept 3)** *no readings or reflections*

**2. Climate Change (Sept 10)**

Blanchard, O., Gollier, C. and Tirole, J., 2023. [The portfolio of economic policies needed to fight climate change](#). *Annual Review of Economics*, 15(1), pp.689-722. (2 hours)

Tombe, T., & Winter, J. (2024). [Does Emissions Pricing Hurt Affordability? Quantifying the Effects on Canadian Households](#). IRPP Study No. 94. Montreal: Institute for Research on Public Policy (1.5 hours)

John Vaillant, 2023. *Fire Weather: The Making of a Beast*. Chapter 2. (25 minutes, audio)

### 3. Productivity (Sept 17)

RBC Economics. 2024. [Canada's Growth Challenge: Why the economy is stuck in neutral](#) (1 hour)

André, C. and Gal, P., 2024. [Reviving productivity growth: A review of policies](#). OECD Economics Department Working Papers 1822. (3 hours; skim some sections if you're running out of time)

Energi Talks 2024. (podcast) [From bad to worse: Canada's labour productivity crisis](#) (41 minutes)

Trevor Tombe. 2024. [Canada's resource sector is its productivity powerhouse](#). The Hub. (5 minutes)

### 4. Industrial Policy: Theory and Evidence (Sept 24)

Mariana Mazzucato. 2013. *The Entrepreneurial State: Debunking Public vs. Private Sector Myths*. London: Anthem, Chapters 2 & 3. (2 hours, audio or print)

Juhász, R., Lane, N. and Rodrik, D., 2024. [The new economics of industrial policy](#). *Annual Review of Economics*, 16. (2.5 hours)

### 5. Industrial Policy in Canada (Oct 1)

Commission on Carbon Competitiveness and the Transition Accelerator. 2025. [The Right Move at the Right Time: A new Canadian industrial strategy](#). (3 hours)

Protein Industries Canada: Canada's Agri-food Opportunity: The Road to \$25 Billion (podcast) 2024. [Episode 1 - The Road to \\$25 Billion](#) (0:49)

### 6. Immigration (Oct 8)

The Missing Middle with Mike Moffatt and Sabrina Maddeaux (podcast). [From 40 to 100 million: How will immigration impact Canadian wages?](#) June 11, 2025. (20 minutes)

Doyle, M., Skuterud, M. and Worswick, C., 2025. [The economics of Canadian immigration levels](#). *Canadian Journal of Economics/Revue canadienne d'économie*, 58(1), pp.109-135. (2.5 hours)

Banerjee, R., Verma, A. and Zhang, T., 2019. [Brain gain or brain waste? Horizontal, vertical, and full job-education mismatch and wage progression among skilled immigrant men in Canada](#). *International Migration Review*, 53(3), pp.646-670. (1 hour)

### 7. Interprovincial Trade (Oct 15)

Alvarez, J., Krznar, M.I. and Tombe, T., 2019. [Internal trade in Canada: Case for liberalization](#). International Monetary Fund. (2.5 hours)

WONK with Amanda Lang (podcast): [How to build 'one Canadian economy' - Trevor Tombe on the Simple Fix to Boost Canada's Economy](#) (37 minutes)

CUPE/SCPF. 2025. [Backgrounder on Interprovincial Trade Barriers](#) (30 minutes)

### READING WEEK (Oct 22)

### 8. Housing Affordability (Oct 29)

Missing Middle with Mike Moffatt and Sabrina Maddeaux (podcast). [The Housing Trilemma: Why You Can't Afford a Home](#). May 21, 2025. (0:21)

Gordon, J.C., 2020. [Reconnecting the housing market to the labour market: Foreign ownership and housing affordability in urban Canada](#). *Canadian Public Policy*, 46(1), pp.1-22. (1.5 hours)

Li J. Tax Reform: A Missing Piece in Canada's National Housing Policy. In: Stephanie Ben-Ishai, ed. [Dangerous Opportunities: The Future of Financial Institutions, Housing Policy, and Governance](#) (University of Toronto Press, 2021, Chapter Five.) (1 hour)

## NO CLASS – work on term project (Nov 5)

### 9. Homelessness and poverty (Nov 12)

UCLA Housing Voice (podcast) Pathways Home: A Limited Series on Homelessness Policy & Research. Ep 61: [Homelessness is a Housing Problem with Gregg Colburn](#) (1:07)

Peng, Y., Hahn, R. A., Finnie, R. K., Cobb, J., Williams, S. P., Fielding, J. E., ... & Fullilove, M. T. (2020). [Permanent supportive housing with housing first to reduce homelessness and promote health among homeless populations with disability: a community guide systematic review](#). *Journal of Public Health Management and Practice*, 26(5), 404-411.

Dwyer, R., Palepu, A., Williams, C., Daly-Grafstein, D. and Zhao, J., 2023. [Unconditional cash transfers reduce homelessness](#). *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 120(36), p.e2222103120.

### 10. Healthcare (Nov 19)

Barua, Bacchus, and Mackenzie Moir. 2022. "[Understanding Universal Health Care Reform Options: Cost-Sharing for Patients](#)." Fraser Institute.

Section 1 Health Insurance, Moral Hazard, and Cost-Sharing – a Theoretical Framework

Section 2 – Empirical Evidence on the Possible Consequences of Cost-Sharing

up to p. 16 only (stop at country case studies)

Section 4 - Exploring the Correlation among Cost-Sharing, Wait Times, and Financial Barriers to Medical Care

Summary and Conclusion

### 11. Group Presentations (Nov 26 - Dec 3)

## VII. EVALUATION

Standing in a course is determined by the course instructor subject to the approval of the Faculty Dean. This means that grades submitted by the instructor may be subject to revision. No grades are final until they have been approved by the Dean.

|                                      |     |
|--------------------------------------|-----|
| Weekly reflections (5% each)         | 45% |
| In-class participation               | 10% |
| Group presentation (December 3)      | 15% |
| Final exam (TBD, during exam period) | 30% |

*Weekly reflections*

Reflections on the assigned readings (minimum 400 words) are due each week Wednesday at noon, starting September 10. These **must be written in Google Docs** and the link submitted via Brightspace. The goal of these reflections is to ensure that everyone has digested the course content ahead of class, so that we can have an interesting discussion. Outsourcing this task to an AI tool would defeat this purpose. **Use of generative AI for writing reflections is therefore not allowed and will result in a grade of zero for the assignment.** To ensure that English language learners are not penalized, I will grade on quality of thought, not quality of writing. Late submissions would likewise defeat the purpose and will not be accepted. You may miss one written reflection without excuse or penalty; if you submit all 10, you will receive a grade based on your highest 9 scores.

Version history will be reviewed to ensure compliance with the AI policy. DO NOT write your reflection on another document and then paste it into a Google Doc as this could result in a grade of zero. **I will call on students to elaborate on written submissions during class, and adjust the grade for that week to reflect demonstrated understanding of the material.**

Prompts to stimulate your thinking will be provided each week, but you need not use these if you wish to reflect on a different aspect of the readings. *One* reflection on the group presentations is required. This reflection is due on Friday, December 5 and may address one or more of the presentations.

*In-class participation*

Participation will be evaluated based on students' demonstration that they have completed the assigned readings, their understanding of this material, and their application and articulation of these ideas in a respectful manner in class. **Missing three or more classes without a documented reason will result in a grade of zero for participation.**

*Group presentation*

Groups of two to four (depending on class size) will work together to identify an economic (e.g., economic growth, productivity, poverty, inequality) or social (environmental, health) challenge in Canada. Groups will deliver to the class a 10 to 20-minute presentation (5 minutes per member) that describes the problem and a potential solution from an economic perspective, and then respond to questions from the instructor and, if time permits, members of the class. At least one source should be cited by each member of your group.

Permissible topics include deeper dives into the issues covered in class (e.g., design of tax policy to attract investment) and topics not directly covered (e.g., effect of AI on youth unemployment, rising intergenerational inequality).

Examples of individual contributions to the presentation include the following:

- Introduce the challenge from an economic perspective (what are the market failures or equity issues at play?)
- Describe the methods and findings of one or two studies on the topic.
- Propose potential solutions to the challenge, and describe how they address the underlying economic issues (market failures, equity concerns).

You only have 5 minutes each, and some parts may take less time than others, so you could also split these suggested pieces up. For example, person 1 could do the intro and describe methods of one paper, person 2 talks about the study findings, and person 3 covers potential solutions.

Students may form their own groups. Individuals without a group will be assigned to a group based on their interests.

The project grade will consist of two components: an individual score out of 10 points for the student's own component of the presentation and response to questions, and a group score out of 5 points for the coherence of the presentation across components.

### *Final exam*

The final exam will be held **in person** during the exam period. It will cover the material in the assigned readings and lectures. You may bring written material into the exam, but electronic devices will not be allowed. Students who live 160 km or more from Ottawa may apply to take and pay a fee for a distance exam. Information on how to apply can be found here: <https://carleton.ca/ses/examination-services/distance-exams/>

### *Grading standards*

The following grading standards will be used for presentations and exams. For written reflections, students will receive 3 points for a reflection of adequate

| Letter grade | CU grade points | Indicates that work is: | % Range | Explanation                                                                                                                                                                            |
|--------------|-----------------|-------------------------|---------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A+           | 12              | Outstanding             | 90-100  | For written work, virtually publishable. Demonstrates exceptional evaluative judgment, outstanding critical thinking, and mastery of technical as well as literary aspects of writing. |
| A            | 11              | Excellent               | 85-89   | Demonstrates superior grasp of material, very strong critical thinking, and capacity to understand and extend underlying patterns.                                                     |
| A-           | 10              | Very Good               | 80-84   | Demonstrates strong grasp of material, its component parts, and capacity to analyze their relationships to each other.                                                                 |
| B+           | 9               | Good                    | 77-79   | Demonstrates clear understanding of material and ability to apply concepts. Written work is competent.                                                                                 |
| B            | 8               | Satisfactory            | 73-76   | Satisfactory, but below average. Demonstrates comprehension of material, reasonable but not strong analytical capacity, with some limitations in the ability to apply concepts.        |
| B-           | 7               | Barely Adequate         | 70-72   | Clearly below average. Demonstrates comprehension and understanding, with limited capacity for application. Communication skills problematic.                                          |
| C+           | 6               | Less Than Adequate      | 67-69   | Did not demonstrate an adequate understanding of the material or the ability to apply the concepts. Writing and/or presentations show serious problems.                                |
| C to D-      |                 |                         | 50-66   | Grades in this range indicate work that is passable in some respects but does not meet the standards of graduate work.                                                                 |
| F            |                 |                         | Failure | Did not meet minimal requirements.                                                                                                                                                     |

## VIII. PLAGIARISM

Please be aware that all work submitted as a requirement of ECON 5065 must be both your own work and produced specifically for this course. Academic offences are serious infractions and will not be tolerated.

Students should consult the University's Academic Integrity Policy concerning academic integrity and instructional offences.

The University Academic Integrity Policy defines plagiarism as “*presenting, whether intentionally or not, the ideas, expression of ideas or work of others as one’s own.*” This includes reproducing or paraphrasing portions of someone else’s published or unpublished material, regardless of the source, and presenting these as one’s own without proper citation or reference to the original source. Examples of sources from which the ideas, expressions of ideas or works of others may be drawn from include but are not limited to: books, articles, papers, literary compositions and phrases, performance compositions, chemical compounds, artworks, laboratory reports, research results, calculations and the results of calculations, diagrams, constructions, computer reports, computer code/software, material on the internet and/or conversations.

Examples of plagiarism include, but are not limited to:

- any submission prepared in whole or in part, by someone else, including the unauthorized use of generative AI tools (e.g. ChatGPT);
- using ideas or direct, verbatim quotations, paraphrased material, algorithms, formulae, scientific or mathematical concepts, or ideas without appropriate acknowledgment in any academic assignment;
- using another’s data or research findings without appropriate acknowledgement;
- submitting a computer program developed in whole or in part by someone else, with or without modifications, as one’s own; and
- failing to acknowledge sources through the use of proper citations when using another’s work and/or failing to use quotations marks.

Plagiarism is a serious offence that cannot be resolved directly by the course’s instructor. The Associate Dean of the Faculty conducts a rigorous investigation, including an interview with the student, when an instructor suspects a piece of work has been plagiarized. Penalties are not trivial. They can include a final grade of “F” for the course.

## IX. USE OF GENERATIVE AI

For ECON 4880/5065, AI and AI-assisted technologies such as ChatGPT, Google Gemini, or Elicit AI should only be used to identify sources and to improve the readability or visual presentation of the group project and **not to replace key writing or analytical tasks** such as synthesizing knowledge, drawing conclusions, or making recommendations.

**Students must disclose and describe any use of AI and AI-assisted technologies.** For example, if you wish to “clean up” your presentation using AI tools, that is fine. But you must write the first draft yourself and edit the cleaned-up version to ensure it captures your meaning correctly. A self-written first draft must be submitted alongside the final version. Authorized use of this technology should be done with human oversight and control, and all work should be reviewed and edited carefully. AI can generate authoritative-sounding output that can be incorrect, incomplete, or biased. Students are ultimately responsible and accountable for the contents of the work. In particular, you must check that all sources suggested by AI tools exist, and that their content is consistent with the way you are citing them. **Cited sources will be reviewed, and grades will be penalized heavily for mischaracterized or nonexistent references.** As noted above, use of generative AI is **not allowed in the preparation of reading reflections.** Unauthorized use of generative AI tools for scholarly work may be considered an offence under Carleton’s Academic Integrity Policy.

## X. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

Classroom teaching and learning activities, including lectures, discussions, presentations, etc. – by both instructors and students – are copy protected and remain the intellectual property of their respective author(s). All course materials, including lecture and presentation slides, outlines, and other materials, are also protected by copyright and remain the intellectual property of their respective author(s).

Students registered in the course may take notes and make copies of course materials for their own educational use only. Students are not permitted to reproduce or distribute lecture notes and course materials publicly for commercial or non-commercial purposes without express written consent from the copyright holder(s).

## **XI. ANTI-RACISM, EQUITY, DIVERSITY AND INCLUSION**

### **Carleton University's Equity, Diversity and Inclusion (EDI) Action Plan Indigenous Strategy Kinàmàgawin**

For confidential inquiries related to harassment, discrimination and Accommodation response, please contact [equity@carleton.ca](mailto:equity@carleton.ca).

#### **Indigenous studies at Carleton**

Students who wish to learn more about Indigenous programming at Carleton are encouraged to contact the Community Coordinator and Administrator, Indigenous Policy and Administration at [IPA@carleton.ca](mailto:IPA@carleton.ca). Also, for information about Carleton's Centre for Indigenous Initiatives and the *Ojigkwanong Indigenous Student Centre* (Patterson Hall 228), please visit <https://carleton.ca/indigenous/>.

## **XII. STATEMENT ON STUDENT MENTAL HEALTH**

As a university student you may experience a range of mental health challenges that significantly impact your academic success and overall well-being. If you need help, please speak to someone. There are numerous resources available both on- and off-campus to support you. Here is a helpful list of resources:

**Emergency Resources (on and off campus):** <https://carleton.ca/health/emergencies-and-crisis/emergency-numbers/>

#### **Carleton Resources:**

- Mental Health and Wellbeing: <https://carleton.ca/wellness/>
- Health & Counselling Services: <https://carleton.ca/health/>
- Paul Menton Centre: <https://carleton.ca/pmc/>
- Academic Advising Centre (AAC): <https://carleton.ca/academicadvising/>
- Centre for Student Academic Support (CSAS): <https://carleton.ca/csas/>
- Equity & Inclusivity Communities: <https://carleton.ca/equity/>

#### **Off Campus Resources:**

- Distress Centre of Ottawa and Region: (613) 238-3311 or TEXT: 343-306-5550, <https://www.dcottawa.on.ca/>
- Mental Health Crisis Service: (613) 722-6914, 1-866-996-0991, <http://www.crisisline.ca/>
- Empower Me: 1-844-741-6389, <https://students.carleton.ca/services/empower-me-counselling-services/>
- Good2Talk: 1-866-925-5454, <https://good2talk.ca/>
- The Walk-In Counselling Clinic: <https://walkincounselling.com>

## **XII. ACADEMIC ACCOMMODATIONS**



Carleton is committed to providing academic accessibility for all individuals. Please review the [processes for academic accommodation requests](#) and ensure the link to this information is included in all course outlines/syllabi for courses you are teaching this academic year.

You may need special arrangements to meet your academic obligations during the term. For an accommodation request the processes are as follows:

**Pregnancy obligation:** Write to me with any requests for academic accommodation during the first two weeks of class, or as soon as possible after the need for accommodation is known to exist. For accommodation regarding a formally-scheduled final exam, you must complete the Pregnancy Accommodation Form: <https://carleton.ca/equity/contact/form-pregnancy-accommodation/>

**Religious obligation:** Write to me with any requests for academic accommodation during the first two weeks of class, or as soon as possible after the need for accommodation is known to exist. For more details see <https://carleton.ca/equity/focus/discrimination-harassment/religious-spiritual-observances/> .

**Academic Accommodations for Students with Disabilities:** The Paul Menton Centre for Students with Disabilities (PMC) provides services to students with Learning Disabilities (LD), psychiatric/mental health disabilities, Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD), Autism Spectrum Disorders (ASD), chronic medical conditions, and impairments in mobility, hearing, and vision. If you have a disability requiring academic accommodations in this course, please contact PMC at 613-520-6608 or [pmc@carleton.ca](mailto:pmc@carleton.ca) for a formal evaluation. If you are already registered with the PMC, please request your accommodations for this course through the [Ventus Student Portal](#) at the beginning of the term, and no later than two weeks before the first in-class scheduled test or exam requiring accommodation (if applicable). Requests made within two weeks will be reviewed on a case-by-case basis. For final exams, the deadlines to request accommodations are published in the [University Academic Calendars](#). After requesting accommodation from PMC, meet with me to ensure accommodation arrangements are made. Please consult the PMC website for the deadline to request accommodations for the formally-scheduled exam (if applicable).

**Survivors of Sexual Violence:** As a community, Carleton University is committed to maintaining a positive learning, working and living environment where sexual violence will not be tolerated, and where survivors are supported through academic accommodations as per Carleton's Sexual Violence Policy. For more information about the services available at the university and to obtain information about sexual violence and/or support, visit: <https://carleton.ca/equity/sexual-assault-support-services>

**Accommodation for Student Activities:** Carleton University recognizes the substantial benefits, both to the individual student and for the university, that result from a student participating in activities beyond the classroom experience. Reasonable accommodation will be provided to students who compete or perform at the national or international level. Write to me with any requests for academic accommodation during the first two weeks of class, or as soon as possible after the need for accommodation is known to exist. <https://carleton.ca/senate/wp-content/uploads/Accommodation-for-Student-Activities-1.pdf>